

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Thinking about consequences.



Learning Outcome

Accurately use information about people's backgrounds in a wider variety of communicative situations.

Ask your partner:

- How are good business decisions made?
- At work, should decisions be made by one person, or should there be a group discussion first? Why?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about feelings and reactions.
- I can speculate about things and express possibility and necessity.
- I can express possibility and necessity.





Let's Explore!

Sally worries that Vanessa is making a **rash decision***

* A "rash decision" is a decision made without enough thought about the consequences.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Vanessa:** Hello?
- Sally:** Hi Vanessa. Listen, I've been thinking about your plan and I'm really uneasy about it. I don't want you to make a rash decision.
- Vanessa:** I know you must be startled by my sudden decision but you ought to hear me out. To begin with, I have given this a lot of thought. I've done some research into local restaurant trends.
- Sally:** You seem confident that more families will be brought to the restaurant by this change but have you thought about the adverse consequences?
- Vanessa:** You must tell me your concerns.
- Sally:** Well, it's true that this change may bring in more families but think about the customers that don't have kids. More alcoholic drinks and food may be ordered by diners that don't have children with them. I think that people who eat out without children tend to spend more money.
- Vanessa:** You have a point. I had better take some more time to consider the negative consequences that could be caused by this change. You have got to think I'm crazy!
- Sally:** No, I think you are ambitious and creative and you had better be appreciated by the owner.
- Vanessa:** Actually, I haven't discussed my idea with the owner yet. I'll present my concept tomorrow. He might be taken aback! Wish me luck!
- Sally:** You must be eager to share your idea! Good luck tomorrow! Let's meet after you talk to the owner and grab a bite.





Let's Practice!

Sally and Vanessa are talking about Vanessa's new idea.

Instructions: Match the beginnings 1 - 5 with the endings a - b to complete each sentence. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

- | | |
|---|--|
| 1. I'm really uneasy about your new plan because ... | a. I'll talk to him as soon as I can. |
| 2. I know you must be startled by my sudden decision, but ... | b. have you thought about the adverse consequences? |
| 3. I know more families may go to the restaurant, but ... | c. but he might be taken aback with my presentation! |
| 4. I'll present my concept tomorrow to the owner, ... | d. I don't want you to make a rash decision. |
| 5. I'm eager to show the owner my new idea! | e. you ought to hear me out. |



Let's Practice!

Vanessa considers her new idea.

Instructions: Underline the word that correctly completes each sentence.

- I know you **are / seem / must** be startled by my sudden decision.
- You **ought / must / had better** to hear me out.
- I **have better / had best / had better** take some more time to consider the negative consequences.
- You **must / may / might** be eager to share your idea. I'm sure of that!
- More families **are / may / ought** come to the restaurant because of this change.





Extension Activity

Research a historical decision.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- On the Internet, research major historical decisions (Google search "historical decisions that changed the world").
- Choose one decision and research it thoroughly.
- Make detailed notes on the decision. Be sure to include how the decision was made and if the decision-maker had help from anyone.
- Present your information to your class or group.



Target Words

- uneasy** (adjective): to feel worried or uncomfortable about something
e.g. I've been thinking about your plan and I'm really uneasy about it. I don't want you to make a rash decision.
- startled** (adjective): to be alarmed and surprised by something
e.g. I know you must be startled by my sudden decision but you ought to hear what I have to say.
- to hear someone out** (expression): to listen to everything someone has to say
e.g. I know you must be startled by my sudden decision but you ought to hear me out.
- adverse** (adjective): something that is in opposition to one's interest
e.g. You seem confident that more families may be brought to the restaurant by this change but have you thought about the adverse consequences?
- to tend to** (verb): to be inclined toward an idea
e.g. I think that people who eat out without children tend to spend more money.
- to have a point** (expression): to have a valid and logical argument
e.g. You have a point. I had better take some more time to consider the negative consequences that could be caused by this change.
- concept** (noun): a structured and previously thought of idea
e.g. Actually, I haven't discussed my idea with the owner yet. I'll present my concept tomorrow.
- taken aback** (adjective): feeling surprised and confused about something
e.g. I'll present my concept tomorrow. He might be taken aback! Wish me luck!
- eager** (adjective): showing an intense desire to do something
e.g. You must be eager to share your idea! Good luck tomorrow!

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I talk about feelings and reactions.

☐ ☐

I speculate about things.

☐ ☐

I express possibility and necessity.

☐ ☐

I research on the Internet and present information to a group.

☐ ☐



Learning Points

Modals for Possibility and Necessity

You use modals when you want to express possibility and necessity.

You use *may*, *might* and *could* to express possibility in the past and in the future.

**Might* suggests that something is less possible than *may*.

- *might* / *might not* + infinitive
- *could* / *could not* + infinitive
- *may* / *may not* + infinitive
- *ought to* (we do not use *ought to* in the negative)

Expressing Necessity

You use *must* or *have to* and *had better* to express that something is necessarily true.

Example:

You must tell me your concerns.

Examples:

- *You really ought to hear me out.*
- *You must tell me your concerns.*
- *I had better take some more time to consider the negative consequences.*
- *Negative consequences could be caused by this change.*





Learning Points

Modal Verbs in the Passive Voice

You use modal verbs to add meaning to other verbs. They come before the dictionary form (infinitive without 'to') of the main verb.

Modal verbs can add meaning connected with certainty or obligation.

You can use modal verbs in the passive voice.

You use the passive voice when you want to focus on the receiver of the action, rather than the 'doer' of the action.

Here is the structure of a passive sentence:

Subject + to be + past participle

Example:

*More money **is spent** by people who don't have children.*

You can add a modal verb before the *To be*.

Subject + modal + to be + past participle

Example:

*More money **may be spent** by people who don't have children.*

Here the sentence now has an additional meaning of possibility, thanks to the modal *may*.

Examples:

- *I know you **must be startled** by my sudden decision.*
- *More families **may be brought** to the restaurant by this change.*
- *More alcoholic drinks and food **may be ordered** by diners that don't have children with them.*

